THE MOUNTAINSIDE NEWS

Volume 2, Number 2 February, 1987

DECEMBER 17 HEARING

On December 17, the court in Berkeley Springs held a hearing on the motion by the group of 7 homeowners who sought to intervene in the lawsuits between CMA and CDC. The judge refused to hear the motion since the suits had already been dismissed pursuant to the settlement between CMA and CDC. The judge further ruled that the homeowners' group would have to prove the dismissal of the suits was improper and should be set aside before they could intervene. No further proceedings were scheduled. The Board, on advice of counsel, is proceeding to implement the terms of the settlement agreement.

THE WATER SYSTEM: SOME IMPORTANT ANNOUNCEMENTS

It is the responsibility of homeowners to maintain their own water system (that is, between the individual meter and the house). Please do not ask the Co-Operations Director (Alice Minnamon) to help with problems at your house. The quickest solution for you is to contact one of the following:

--Bath Services (Evan LeFever) 304/258-3535

--Hunter's Hdwe -- 304/258-2442

--Dawson's Hdwe -- 304/258-2111

WATER (cont.)

If there is a water system problem other than that described above, please notify Alice at 304/258-1611 (that's brother Stan Bigelow's house). Please call only between 7:30 AM and 10:00 PM. We cannot respond to water problems in the late night, so please wait until morning if you discover a problem after 10:30 PM. If Alice is not available directly, someone at Stan's will make sure Alice is notified within an hour of your call.

(cont., p. 2)



THE PASTURE, WINTER

It is still by the barn.
Snow dust masks
the pasture's bony ground.
A hillcrest's graven in the sky.
The killdeer's nest is a memory
in a brown stain of sedge.
Of summer's horses, who
snuffled gently at night
in clouds of fireflies, only
frozen clumps of dung remain.
But past the pond, a bobcat's
tracks festoon the slope,
clear intaglio of a night's affairs.

Kathy Lewis

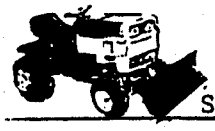
* * *

The poet, from Wheaton, MD, is a former homeowner at Coolfont.

Published by the COOLFONT MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION, Rt. 1, Coolfont Rd., Box 21, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411. Editor: Carol M. Green, 3703 Curtis Court, Chevy Chase MD 20815. Tel.: 301/654-7737

WATER (cont.)

And, finally, it has been pointed out to the Editor that the news of the construction of a new line from the P Well to the North Reservoir was not given proper emphasis! It is a significant improvement and, most importantly, this new leg of the system has been certified by a W. VA state-registered engineer. We now have a second source of water which should increase the reliability of our system.



SNOW REMOVAL

Flip McCoy will continue to remove snow for the Mountainside during the remainder of the winter. We are using the snow list from last year. If there are any additions or subtractions at this time, please call Alice Minnamon or leave a message at 304/258-1611. Homeowners are charged $10 for each driveway cleared and should decide to be on the list or off -- please, no "sometimers."

COOLFONT FOUNDATION

PIANO CONCERT, Marcantonio Barone, Saturday, March 7, 8:30 PM at the Manor House. / Ed. Note: The preceding week Mr. Barone will be performing with the Maryland Symphony in Hagerstown. This group, launched about five years ago by the internationally-known horn player Barry Tuckwell, is alive and well. Anyone interested in more information may call (301) 797-4000. /

MORE ON SPECTRACINE (formerly "septitrine")

Spectracine, an enzyme product which aids in reducing the amount of solids in septic tanks (CMA homes all have one -- even with central system) is available for $10 hrough Alice Minnamon (Coolfont) or Charles Barrett (Silver Spring). Regular usage of this agent will lengthen the time required between pumping out your tanks.

* * * * * * * * *

AN APPEAL FROM THE
DEVELOPMENT & ARCHITECTURAL CONTROL COMMITTEE

The "Guidelines for Building at Coolfont" are now over thirteen years old. Over the last several years we have all recognized deficiencies, omissions or needed clarifications in the use and interpretation of the current Guidelines. We are therefore soliciting your help in updating and revising the Guidelines, using the existing ones as a reference.* The following is a list, by no means all-inclusive, of areas that need to be considered for revision or inclusion in the Guidelines:

1. Provisions called for in the By-laws and Covenants;
2. DACC "walking of property" and approval process;
3. Items that affect ease of maintenance and avoid problems later on / Note: many homeowners might have some suggestions here/
4. Septic tanks: number, Miller siphons, requirements for pumping out, etc.;
5. Foundations, crawl spaces, etc.;
6. Specification as to minimum size house permitted;
7. Selection and approval process for exterior colors;
8. Revised language relative to fire prevention;
9. Change in title of Guidelines to expand and explain the contents; and
10. Any other suggestions.

* If you should need a copy of the existing Guidelines for reference, please call Don Fox (301-427-8804). Your constructive assistance will be most welcome.

LETTERS

/ Ed. Note: Following is a report on a nature walk in the woods of Coolfont as received from Julie Fox, age 9. /



Things We Saw (below)

(1) Fresh mink tracks*
(2) Deer tracks 50 feet away from Treetop
(3) Squirrel tracks*
(4) Evidence of beaver's fallen tree.
(5) Red fox tracks
(6) Woodpecker tree with squirrel's nest inside

Things We Learned (below)

(1) Woodpeckers only make holes in dead trees
(2) Many wild animals are killed on (cont.)

the mountainside road because the mountain is heavily wooded and dark and "food" for them doesn't grow there. In the process of eating, a car may drive down the road at night. The animal's instinct tells them to run. The car's headlights blind them so they wait till they can see again. By then the car has reached the animal and the animal gets run over.
(3) The trees in Coolfont are at least between 60-70 years old. Before today's trees, Coolfont's trees were cut down and mainly used for lumber.

A credit is to be made: to Jon, our guide.

*in the snow

NEW MEMBERS

A warm welcome to the following who have recently bought lots at Coolfont:

--Don and Gerry Markle of Arlington, VA (lot K-13 from John McCloud).

--Marjorie Ross of Washington, (P-6).

and to Joseph Shields and Mary Verdieck of Washington, D.C. who bought John and Kerin Yates house (G-2).

A QUICK HISTORY LESSON

The name "Coolfont" refers to the cold spring adjacent to the Manor House which was built in 1912 by Herbert Quick, a novelist, humanitarian and one of West Virginia's most distinguished citizens. He was responsible for the evolution of the Farm Credit System as we know it today.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

NEXT BOARD MEETING Saturday, March 14, 9:00 AM at the office of Charles Barrett, 8719 Colesville Rd., Suite 315, Silver Spring, MD, Phone:587-0422. Open to the membership, as always.

DICK MINNAMON MEMORIAL

For those CMA members who have expressed interest, you may now contribute in the memory of Dick Minnamon, former CMA resident and Operations Manager, to the ongoing research at Johns Hopkins in the field of prostate cancer research. To reach the maximum number of Dick's friends in the CMA community we are including the following tear-off form which was drawn up in conversations with Alice and in keeping with the specific wishes of the family. You may specify the area of research you prefer.

Contributions are to be sent to:

Development Office
Oncology Center
Johns Hopkins University
550 North Broadway
Baltimore, MD 21205

THIS MEMORIAL CONTRIBUTION IS GIVEN IN MEMORY OF RICHARD MINNAMON. IT IS MY DESIRE THAT IT BE USED TO SUPPORT THE FOLLOWING AREA(S) OF PROSTATIC CANCER RESEARCH:

_____1. Specialized nuclear imaging, techniques to identify aggressive prostatic cancer

_____2. Early detection and diagnosis

_____3. Surgery with early diagnosis, without harmful side-effects